which had become so deeply embedded."[79] At this critical juncture of the book, she provides a sharp contrast between border crossings and life on both sides of the border, as well as programs of antiracism and denazification built into the respective German cultural systems.

By even mentioning "the wall" in reference to the Berlin border in this section of the book, as noted, Davis violates East German mandate and linguistic convention. In the book, she depicts the Wall while also nodding to a cultural rite of dissidence in the East by not specifically naming it. In this context, we see how Davis's refusal to name the Wall in her autobiography displays both an allegiance to and a violation of East German mores. Davis's reference to "the wall" is both a subtle acknowledgment and a disavowal of the shared strategies of suppression of both East and West. She does not acknowledge the repressive tactics of the East, including the building of the Berlin Wall itself. Instead, Davis positions walls as a signature structure for characterizing America and the West. She alludes to and then turns away from the Berlin Wall as a means of critically pivoting perspective in a narrative that more fully explores the repressive architecture of American political life.

In the next chapter, titled "Flames," she recounts her burgeoning activism around prisons during the transitional period of her return to America: "I became convinced that there were impending explosions behind the walls, and that if we did not begin to build a support movement for our sisters and brothers in prison, we were no revolutionaries at all. … The gray walls, the sounds of chains had touched not only their lives, but the lives of all Black people."[80] Later, in describing the longtime incarceration of George Jackson, she offset the designation "behind walls" between two em-dashes, as an emphatic description and geopolitical location.[81] Her treatment of walls as a literary symbol is fully realized as the central repressive architecture of society and the site of her most intense critical engagement.

In the final two chapters of the book, titled, respectively, "Walls" and "Bridges," Davis picks up with her detention in California and explains the case that the state made against her and the evolution of the legal circumstances that led to the trial. She uses an image of walls from the very first page of "Walls." The epigraph to this chapter is excerpted from "Poem with Rhythms," by Wallace Stevens:

> The hand between the candle and the wall
> Grows large on the wall. …